

idle

Suncatcher Mobile



Instruction Booklet



Hey You,

I'm so happy that you found this Suncatcher Mobile DIY-kit, and are about to embark on a journey of **designing your own work of glimmering art!**

I hope that the experience will be peaceful and filled with play and discovery. In this booklet, I have written down **instructions on how to build one** - but no need to follow these if you don't feel like it! I hope that you let your creativity guide your process and trust your gut. I for one am sure that you will create something beautiful!

If you come across any issues or need assistance, know that I'm always here to reach out to! I'd be happy to help with big or small problems. You can find my contact information at the end of the booklet.

Have fun playing with colours and shapes!

Love, Iida

1 Contents of the Kit

Acrylic Pieces

All the acrylic pieces are designed and lasercut locally by Idle.

When planning how to connect the pieces, pay attention on where the **pre-cut holes** are located! This is where the jump rings connect to the acrylic pieces. Some of the pieces might still have **protective films** on them - peel them off when the mobile is ready.



Frame

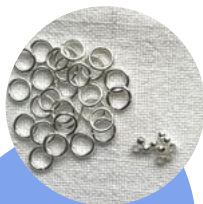
The frames are handmade from either brass or aluminum.

They are designed to be **adjustable** - you can gently wiggle the point where the chain wraps around the frame to change the balance point! You'll learn more about adjusting the balance later in this booklet.

Jump Rings & Crimp Beads

There are two kinds of small metal pieces: jump rings and crimp beads.

The jump rings are used to connect the acrylic pieces to each other to form elements. The crimp beads close around the fishing wire, and attach the acrylic elements to the frame neatly.



Jump Ring Tool

The big metal ring is the tool you're least likely to have seen before!

This handy thing is used to help you **open and close the small jump rings**. The instructions for using it are included later in this booklet.

You Also Need:

A pair of small pliers, for example chain nose pliers or other jewelry pliers.



2 Getting Started

Time to start composing your Suncatcher Mobile

I always recommend to start composing the pieces **flat on a table**. As you can see, the metal frames have three connection points, so we shall be composing a total of **three elements consisting of multiple acrylic pieces**

each. In order to not feel too overwhelmed with possibilities, it might be best to start with composing one element that you really like, and build the others to complement that!

The elements can be of different sizes and lengths, or all similar, depending on whether you prefer a more structured or organic and abundant look. If you're looking for consistency, I recommend finding something that visually connects the elements to each other - maybe a specific colour or a shape that repeats across the different elements.

3 Connecting the Pieces

The composition doesn't need to be perfect before you move to the next stage - thankfully jump rings can be opened and the design adjusted!

The acrylic pieces are connected to each other using one or more jump rings. The more rings you use between pieces, **the more movement it creates** as the pieces spin in relation to each other. It is also good to notice that using an **uneven** number of rings is going to lead to the pieces

resting **parallel** to each other, and using an **even** number of rings is going to lead to the pieces resting **perpendicular** to each other.

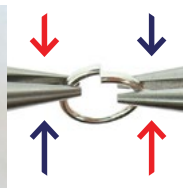
The pictures below show the correct way to open and close jump rings. It is important to **twist**, not try to pull open like you would a book, as the latter would misform and weaken the rings.

If the technique feels difficult to grasp, there are plenty of great tutorial videos online!

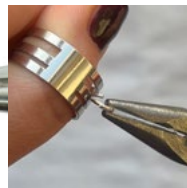
connections with three jump rings



blue arrows open, red arrows close.



same twist with the jump ring tool



4 Finding Balance

The most interesting (or painstaking) part of making a mobile is finding that perfect visual and physical balance.

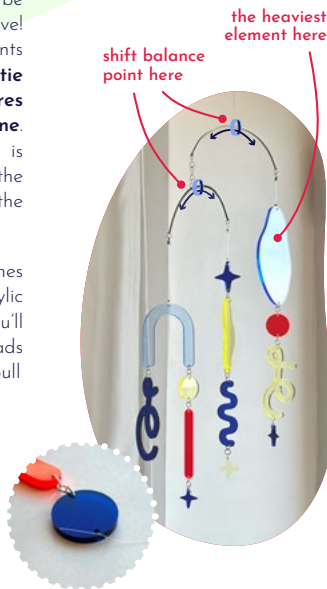
And, of course, this cannot be done without seeing it move! Once you have three elements that you're happy with, **tie them to the fishing wire hanging from the frame**. If one of your elements is noticeably heavier than the others, attach that to the upper arch.

Tie the fishing lines **temporarily** to the acrylic with simple double-knots. You'll replace them with crimp beads in the next step, so don't pull them too tight!

When you lift the mobile, you may find that **what looks good on the table doesn't quite work in the air**. This is why we spend

some time here adjusting the design and balance.

If the **frame tilts** to one side more than you'd like, you can remove pieces from the heavier side, add to the lighter side, or shift the balance point of the frame by gently moving the fishing wire or jump ring along the arch.



For visual balance, you can play with **the heights of the different elements** by chaging how much fishing wire (or, looking back at the previous step, chained jump rings) you leave between the pieces and the frame. If the mobile feels too busy, it's often because **too many elements sit at the same height**. Ensuring that the different focal points of the mobile don't block each other usually makes a big difference!

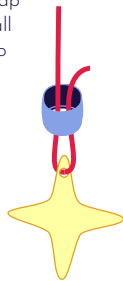
5 Finishing Touches

Once your mobile looks beautiful and moves like you want it to, it's time for the finishing touches!

While simple knots work, I've included crimp beads so you can finish the mobile with a clean look. Crimp beads can't be reopened, so **only use them when you're fully happy with the design!**

To attach a crimp bead, first measure the length that you want the fishing wire to be, then open the temporary knot. Thread the wire through the bead, the piece, and back through the bead. Squeeze the bead tight with pliers, then tug both ends of the wire to make sure that it holds. Trim the extra wire, leaving a tail of a few millimeters.

Huge congratulations, the mobile is completed! You can polish the acrylic pieces with a microfiber cloth and some dishwashing soap if needed. Then all that's left to do is **enjoy the idle moments watching your new, unique, glimmering Suncatcher Mobile!**



Troubleshooting

A few common problems that makers might encounter, along with their solutions!

The jump ring will not go in the hole in the acrylic piece

There are a few things that might block the way of the jump ring. First, check whether the hole is properly open. Sometimes a little piece of acrylic remains stuck in the hole after cutting, but thankfully most of the time that pops off easily when poked with either the tip of the pliers or a needle!

If that doesn't work, it might be that the piece is from one of my previous edition batches, where the holes were a bit smaller. You could try straightening the jump ring as straight wire goes through a smaller hole than bent one. If neither of these tricks work, please reach out to me so we can attempt to solve the problem together!

The acrylic piece looks dull or scratched

Some of the pieces might still have a protective film on. The

film surface doesn't have the same shine as acrylic, and it also feels softer to the touch. This protective film can be peeled off.

If the surface looks dull despite not having a film, you can reach out and we'll see what we can do to solve the problem!

The mobile doesn't look like what you want it to look like

As a perfectionist, I know that the design process can sometimes be slow or difficult! The first remedy to that pain of creation for me is usually to take a step back and have a break. It's crazy what looking at the same thing with fresh eyes can do!

If you still feel stuck or not happy with the design, I recommend focusing on creating one element that you really like first, and then building the other elements to complement it. Maybe your favourite element can be really large and detailed, and the supporting elements simple?

Finally, if you think that it would help you, you can also send me a message and I can give some guidance! But that being said, I strongly believe that your gut is the most important thing to follow, not my opinions :)

Closing Remarks

Maybe by now you are admiring your finished Suncatcher Mobile, or maybe you just read this booklet all the way to the end before starting to work. If it's the latter, I do envy your patience!

Again, if you encounter any problems now or down the line, do not hesitate to contact me! I've designed the concept to be durable and bring you joy for years to come, so if anything would break, I hope you let me know so that we can figure out a way forward together.

Finally, **I would love to see your finished Suncatcher Mobile designs!** Feel free to send me a picture of the finished piece or tag me on social media, it will make my day.

Wishing you lots of joy of creation and idle moments to come!



